



The spy game

Take a look at this article to know more about spies and their clandestine lives
<http://digit.in/16uYqXV>

EA appoints new CEO

EA veteran Andrew Wilson was appointed as the new CEO of Electronic Arts, replacing John Riccitiello. He'll be paid an annual salary of \$800,000



Rootin Tootin Routers

Super fast routers go head to head in this shootout featuring both single and dual band routers

devices have scaled up a bit and maximum throughput is currently 600 Mbps on the 2.4GHz band and 1300 Mbps on the 5 GHz band. If you'd have paid any attention to these figures then having 600 Mbps on the 2.4 GHz should've stood out since it was limited to 450 Mbps till now. The increment is due to a new modulation algorithm, 256QAM (Quadrature Amplitude Modulation); currently only Broadcom has this technology so you can expect Broadcom-to-Broadcom communication to hit the 1900 Mbps limit while all other devices will still be limited to 1750 Mbps. Broadcom calls this TurboQAM and we saw it in action in the ASUS PCE-A68 that we used as a reference card in our test.

We also saw our first Dual-core processor based router – ASUS RT-AC68U which has a Broadcom BCM4708A. Rated at 1GHz, this processor is faster than that on a lot of the smartphones we have in the market. Let's hope this doesn't kick off

an unnecessary CPU war in this category though.

Interface

Something that usually gets overlooked is the firmware that routers ship with. Most manufacturers seem to be deliberately restricting the functionality of lower-end routers to push their higher-end models. As long the router supports custom firmware such as Tomato or DD-WRT and others, you shouldn't be worried about this. That being said, installing the said custom firmware does require a fair amount of networking and programming knowledge and it isn't something that amateurs should take lightly.

Of note here is ASUS, which is doing something that we wish more manufacturers would do, namely, releasing the source-code to their firmware! This is a boon for geeks the world over and something that should translate to increased sales considering the increased customisability

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There is a minor caveat though, most devices will probably be based on the draft 802.11ac specifications. Nevertheless, the tech grapevine is rife with rumours regarding the next 802.11ac capable mobile device, laptop and tablet.

So what's new?

Well pretty much nothing actually. The current 802.11ac

Picking up an 802.11ac certified router would have been almost impossible last year, given the rarity and price of compatible devices. Things have changed though and 802.11ac can now be officially labelled as mainstream.